

Curriculum Alignment — Digital Independence Path

1. Understanding of the Official Curriculum

Ages: 15–18 **Structure:** 3 courses × 8 lessons = 24 lessons **Progression:** Identity → Services → Clients → Professional Presence → Opportunities (explicitly *not* Fiverr → Upwork → LinkedIn)

The path is evidence-driven, not access-driven: it does not assume a student can or should independently open adult marketplace or professional-network accounts. It teaches the underlying professional skill first (define your value, package a service, communicate like a professional, build reputation), and treats real platforms as case studies with their real age/account rules — never as something to work around.

Course 16 — Build Your Professional Identity

Turns existing Lumexa projects into honest, credible proof of skill via a live portfolio site, brand kit, case studies, and a professional bio. Tools: HTML, CSS, Vercel, Canva, GitHub, Google Docs. Deliverables: live portfolio website · personal brand kit · 2–3 project case studies · professional intro/bio. Lessons: (1) What professional identity means in the digital age (2) Define your strengths and direction (3) Build your portfolio website (4) Tell your story professionally (5) Create your personal brand (6) Turn projects into proof (7) Launch your professional website (8) Build social proof.

Course 17 — Skills That Pay

Teaches how a skill becomes a service and a service becomes a professional opportunity — without assuming marketplace access. Culminates in a full simulated client project. Tools: Google Docs, Canva, Notion, Email, Spreadsheets. Deliverables: professional service package · pricing worksheet · proposal + client/project brief · full simulated client project. Lessons: (1) How the freelance economy works (2) Turn a skill into a service (3) Build a service package (4) Pricing, scope, and agreements (5) Finding your first opportunities (6) Marketplace models: what changes at different ages? (7) Proposals, communication, and delivery (8) The client simulation.

Course 18 — Professional Presence & Opportunity Building

Builds reputation and communication skill using LinkedIn where age-eligible, and an equally credible portfolio-first alternative where not. Tools: LinkedIn (age-eligible), Canva, Google Docs, content-planning tools. Deliverables: professional profile/presence · 5 pieces of professional content · networking plan · 90-day growth plan. Lessons: (1) Your professional presence (2) Build your professional profile (3) Showcase your work (4) Share what you know (5) Build a professional presence beyond LinkedIn (6) Networking and professional communication (7) Build your 90-day opportunity plan (8) Measure, reflect, and improve.

2. How the Three Courses Connect

Course 16 produces the *evidence* (portfolio, case studies). Course 17 turns that evidence into a *sellable, priced service* and proves the student can execute a full client engagement safely, in simulation. Course 18 makes that evidence and service *discoverable* and turns one finished project into an ongoing pipeline of opportunity, via reputation and communication. No later course requires an adult platform account the student does not already legally hold.

3. Age-Safety Rules Applied Throughout

- Never instructs falsifying age, bypassing verification, or using another person's account.
- Platform mentions (Fiverr, Upwork, Etsy, Gumroad, LinkedIn) always paired with their real age/account rules, flagged as subject to change/local law, and taught as case studies.
- LinkedIn requires 16+ (subject to local law/parental consent rules) — students below the applicable age use the Course 18 portfolio-first alternative instead of creating an account.
- All client work is simulated and clearly labeled fictional/educational; no real payments, real clients, or real contracts are used or implied to be legally binding.

4. Assumptions Made (flagged for your review)

- Domain/hosting: Vercel's free tier is assumed for lesson 7 (no purchase required).
- "GitHub" use is scoped to creating a public repo and pushing code — not collaboration workflows (PRs, branching) which are out of scope for this path.
- Where the official PDF doesn't specify exact worksheet formats, I designed original templates consistent with the stated deliverables.
- Space-themed visual identity is an original design (not reproduced official brand assets).